

ENG508

→ Definition of Semantics and Pragmatics

Semantics studies the meaning of language, focusing on words, phrases, and sentences. Pragmatics examines how context influences language interpretation.

→ The Borderline between Semantics and Pragmatics

The semantics-pragmatics boundary is blurry, as meaning depends on both linguistic structure and contextual factors.

→ Sentence and Utterance

- Sentence: a linguistic unit
- Utterance: the spoken or written realization of a sentence

→ Language and Logic

Language and logic intersect in semantic analysis, using logical tools to understand linguistic meaning.

→ The Explicit and the Implicit

- Explicit meaning: directly stated
- Implicit meaning: inferred from context

→ Semantics in Linguistics

Linguistic semantics investigates meaning within language systems.

→ Semantics in a Model of Grammar

Semantic components integrate with:

- Phonology
- Syntax
- Pragmatics

→ Historical Semantics

Historical semantics studies language meaning changes over time.

→ Semantics in Other Disciplines

Semantics intersects with:

- Philosophy
- Psychology
- Anthropology
- Computer Science

→ Semantics and Semiotics

- Semiotics: explores signs and symbols
- Semantics: focuses on linguistic meaning

→ Reference and Sense

- Reference: connects words to objects
- Sense: captures conceptual meaning

→ Utterance, Sentence, and Proposition

- Utterance: conveys a sentence
- Sentence: expresses a proposition (statement or assertion)

→ Literal and Non-Literal Meaning

- Literal meaning: direct
- Non-literal meaning: metaphor, irony, or inference

→ Theories of Meaning

Theories include:

- Idea Theory (mental concepts)
- Reference Theory (objective reference)
- Use Theory (language use)
- Truth-Conditional Theory (truth conditions)

→ What Is Meaning?

Meaning is the relationship between language and concept or object.

→ Meaning Holism

Meaning holism: meaning emerges from language as a whole.

Meaning within Language

Meaning determined by linguistic structure and context.

→ Idea Theory of Meaning

Idea Theory: meaning resides in mental concepts.

➡ **Meanings Are Out in the World**

Reference Theory: meaning grounded in objective reality.

Some notable theories and models include:

- Truth-Conditional Semantics
- Model-Theoretic Semantics
- Relevance Theory
- Speech Act Theory
- Gricean Pragmatics

➡ **Meaning of Sentences and Truth Condition**

Sentence meaning is determined by truth conditions, which specify when a sentence is true or false.

➡ **Compositional Theory**

Compositional theory posits that sentence meaning derives from combining word meanings.

➡ **Kinds of Meaning**

- Linguistic/Conceptual Meaning: relates to word concepts
- Connotative/Referential Meaning: associates words with emotions or objects
- Social Meaning: reflects social context
- Affective Meaning: evokes emotions
- Reflective and Collocative Meaning: depends on word relationships
- Thematic Meaning: concerns sentence themes

➡ **Meaning, Thought, and Reality**

- Sense and Concepts: words convey concepts
- Necessary and Sufficient Conditions: define concept boundaries
- Prototypes: concepts have central and peripheral instances
- Linguistic Relativity: language influences thought
- Language of Thought Hypothesis: thought precedes language

➡ **Lexical Relations**

Lexical relations connect words:

- Synonyms (similar meaning)
- Antonyms (opposite meaning)
- Hyponym (specific to general)
- Meronym (part to whole)
- Homonym (same spelling, different meaning)
- Polysemy (related meanings)

→ Lexical Semantics: Fields and Collocation

- Semantic Fields: words group by meaning
- Collocations: word combinations
- Idioms: fixed expressions

→ Sentence Relations and Truth

- Logic and Truth: sentence truth conditions
- Propositional Logic: simple sentences
- Predicate Logic: complex sentences
- Entailment: logical implications
- Truth Conditional Semantics: sentence meaning from truth conditions

→ Presupposition

Presupposition assumes shared knowledge.

→ Tense and Aspect

Tense (time) and aspect (duration) modify verb meaning.

→ Modality

Modality expresses possibility, necessity, or obligation.

→ Mood

Mood conveys speaker attitude.

→ Evidentiality

Evidentiality indicates information sources.

→ Thematic Roles

Thematic roles identify participant relationships:

- Agent (actor)
- Patient (affected)
- Theme (object)
- Experiencer (feeling)
- Beneficiary (receiver)
- Instrument (means)
- Location (place)
- Goal (destination)
- Source (origin)
- Stimulus (trigger)

→ Grammatical Categories

Grammatical categories include:

- Nouns
- Verbs
- Adjectives
- Adverbs

→ Grammatical Relations

Grammatical relations connect words:

- Subject
- Object
- Modifier

→ Relationship with other Fields

Semantics intersects with philosophy, psychology, and computer science

→ Types of Lexical Rules

- Graded Accessibility
- Other Observations

→ What is Pragmatics?

Pragmatics studies how language users convey meaning in context, considering speaker intention, listener interpretation, and social settings.

→ Types of Pragmatics

- Clinical Pragmatics (communication disorders)
- Developmental Pragmatics (language acquisition)
- Interlanguage Pragmatics (second language use)
- Neuropragmatics (brain-language relationships)
- Social Pragmatics (social interaction)

→ What Does Pragmatics Study?

Pragmatics examines:

- Speech acts (assertions, questions, commands)
- Implicature (implied meaning)
- Presupposition (assumed knowledge)
- Inference (derived meaning)
- Contextualization

→ Pragmatics and Linguistics

Pragmatics complements linguistics by focusing on language use beyond structural analysis.

➡ **The Emergence of Pragmatics as a Distinct Field**

Pragmatics emerged in the 1960s-70s, recognizing the importance of context in language understanding.

➡ **Development and Expansion of Pragmatics**

Pragmatics has expanded to include:

- Discourse analysis
- Conversation analysis
- Relevance theory
- Cognitive pragmatics

➡ **The Prehistory of Pragmatics**

Early influences include:

- Aristotle's rhetoric
- Wittgenstein's philosophical investigations
- Austin's speech act theory

➡ **Modern Pragmatics**

Modern pragmatics integrates:

- Cognitive science
- Social science
- Linguistics

➡ **Context and Pragmatics**

Context types:

- Situational context (physical setting)
- Background knowledge (shared information)
- Co-textual context (linguistic environment)

➡ **Referring to the Context Inside: Cohesion**

Cohesion links text elements:

- Grammatical cohesion (pronouns, conjunctions)
- Lexical cohesion (repetition, synonyms)

➡ **Implicature and Inference**

Implicature and inference facilitate communication beyond literal meaning.